ful wave of materialistic philosophy, agnosticism, atheism. O u t of this again grew Buddhism and Jainism, and the famous Sanskrit epics, the R a m a y a n a and the M a h a b h a r a t a , wherein yet another attempt was made to bring about a synthesis between rival creeds and ways of thought. T h e creative energy of the people, or of the creative minority, is very evident during these periods, and again there appears to be a bond between that minority and the majority. On the whole they pull together.

In this way period succeeds period with bursts of creative effort in the fields of thought and action, in literature a n d the drama, in sculpture and architecture, and in cultural, missionary a n d

colonial enterprises far from India's borders. In between, there are periods of disharmony and conflict, due both to inner causes and intrusions from outside. Yet they are ultimately overcome and a fresh period of creative energy supervenes. The last great period of such activity in a variety of directions was the classical epoch which began in the fourth century after Christ. By about 1000 **A.C.,** or earlier, signs of inner decay in India are very evident. although the old artistic impulse continued to function